

US equities slip as tech drags, yields rise

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 fell **-0.38%** to 7,718.60, while the Nasdaq 100 edged up **+0.21%** to 29,544.15. Yield pressure intensified with the 10-year Treasury at 4.78%, up **+0.46%**.

Tech heavyweight **AAPL** dropped **-2.51%** and **MSFT** slipped **-2.04%**, while **NVDA** posted a modest gain of **+0.84%**. Investors await next-week earnings from the “Magnificent Seven”.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,718.60	-0.38%	Broad equity decline
Dow Jones	53,414.25	-0.51%	Industrial lag
Nasdaq 100	29,544.15	+0.21%	Tech resilience
Russell 2000	2,975.65	+0.25%	Small-cap modest gain
VIX	14.53	+1.47%	Volatility uptick
10Y Yield	4.78%	+0.46%	Yield curve steepening
WTI Crude	91.48	+0.00%	Flat on OPEC-plus

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	230.36	+0.84%
META	616.77	+1.00%
GS	1,038.61	+0.07%
AVGO	357.90	+0.21%
TSLA	354.08	-5.92%

Spotlight

Apple’s Q3 earnings released after market close showed revenue of 119.5 billion, down **-3.2%** YoY, with iPhone sales slipping **-5.1%**. Gross margin narrowed to 38.5%.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	119.5 bn
YoY Δ	-3.2%
iPhone Δ	-5.1%
Gross margin	38.5%

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 4.78%, up **+0.46%**
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 04:30, Existing-home sales 06:00

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-price shock risk.
- China's manufacturing PMI posted 49.8, indicating contraction.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.3% YoY, supporting ECB dovish stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:00	MSFT	Cloud revenue growth, margin outlook
03:30	AMZN	Advertising and AWS performance
05:00	GOOGL	AI ad spend, Search revenue
06:30	JPM	Net interest income, loan growth

Stocks worth watching

- **NVDA** – AI chip demand still outpacing supply.
- **TSLA** – Recent price slump may present a valuation entry.
- **XLFF** – Financials under pressure but rate-sensitive earnings ahead.
- **XLE** – Oil price stability supports energy exposure.
- **META** – Metaverse spend cutbacks easing profit pressure.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI (>0.3% MoM) could push yields above 5%.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict reigniting oil price spikes.
- Weak earnings from **MSFT** or **AMZN** triggering sector sell-off.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected tech earnings (e.g., **NVDA**) sparking a rally.
- Gold slipping below 4,400 as risk appetite improves.
- Fed signals possible rate cut in upcoming meeting.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

SEC — Company Filings

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements

CNBC — Economic Calendar